

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Just call me "Stealer".



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever done something wrong when you were young?
- What happened? Do you regret it?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about sports and interests.
- I can write a short text about past experiences.
- I can write about people's past experiences and past habits.





Let's Explore!

Jason writes about an experience in the past. Did he **regret*** his poor decision?

* To "regret" means to feel sad or sorry about something that you did.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

When I was eleven years old, I stole a football.

I have always enjoyed sporting events. My cousin and I would often go to football games. We would always buy a hot dog and soft drink at the game. We used to sit near the edge of the field to soak up the atmosphere.

One day, my eyes were fixed on an extra ball on the sideline. I casually picked it up and walked out of the stadium.

As soon as I left, I was sorry. I noticed a huge guy standing nearby and thought he could be a policeman.

The powerful man came over to me. "Nice football," he said. I could have fainted.

I answered in a whisper, "Would you arrest me for something so small?"

The big man looked puzzled. "Why should I arrest you?"

"I stole this football," I said.

The man smiled. "I'm not a policeman," he said. "You could return the football if you wanted to."

"I can't," I said. "I would be in big trouble."

He took two steps forward and punted it. I couldn't believe my eyes.

"You could be a football player," I said, amazed.

"I am a football player," the big man said smiling. "And I think you might be one someday."

"Don't I wish," I said.

"I think I can take care of that," my new protector said. "I used to be just like you".

That's the story of how I was "discovered" and how I have had a lot of interesting experiences. Ten years later, I became a star on the same football team. My nickname was "Stealer." No one but the coach knew why!





Let's Practice!

Time to talk about the past..

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Practice saying them aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I / games / go / My / cousin / and / would / often / football / to / .

2. buy / We / a / would / game / drink / . / the / at / soft / always

3. the / field / near / soak / up / edge / atmosphere / the / used / of / sit / . / to / We / the
to

4. to / be / . / like / you / just / used / I



Let's Practice!

Instructions: Match the images with the sentences. Based on the sentences and the images, invent a story and tell it to your partner. Listen to your partner's story.



1. One day, my eyes were fixed on an extra ball on the sideline.
2. I casually picked it up and walked out of the stadium.
3. No one but the coach knew why.
4. I'm a policeman.
5. We would always buy a hot dog at the game.





Extension Activity

Time to use your listening skills. Let's learn about the interests of others.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Interview an older person in your family or community about a past experience they had. Ask 5 questions like, *"Can you tell me about a sport you played or watched in the past?"*
- Write notes based on the answers.
- Write an 80 to 100 word paragraph using the notes. Use the Present Perfect tense and the Past tense.
- Also, include a sentence with the words *used to* or *would*.
- Read the paragraph aloud to the interviewee (the person you interviewed).

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I interview someone in the community about their interests.

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I listen and take notes about someone's experiences.

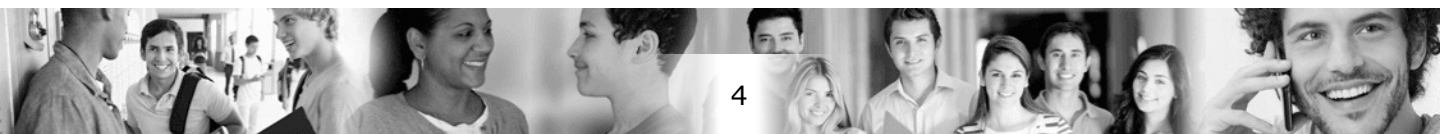
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I write a paragraph about past experiences.

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Target Words

- **to steal** (verb): to take something that does not belong to you
e.g. When I was eleven years old, I stole a football.
- **to soak up** (verb): to take something in
e.g. We used to sit near the edge of the field to soak up the experience.
- **atmosphere** (noun): the particular way a place or situation makes you feel
e.g. There was a wonderful atmosphere at the game.
- **to faint** (verb): to feel weak and dizzy
e.g. I could have fainted.
- **to punt** (verb): to drop a ball and kick it before it touches the ground
e.g. He took two steps forward and punted it.
- **to be discovered** (expression): to be found to have special skills and experience.
e.g. That's the story of how I was "discovered" and how I have had a lot of interesting experiences.
- **sideline** (noun): a line that marks the outside edge of a sports field or court
e.g. One day, my eyes were fixed on an extra ball on the sideline.
- **protector** (noun): a person or thing that protects someone or something
e.g. "I think I can take care of that," my new protector said.
- **coach** (noun): a person who teaches and trains an athlete or performer
e.g. No one but the coach knew why!





Learning Points

Present Perfect Tense vs. Past Simple

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a finished action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about a finished action or event **not** necessarily connected to the present.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience. When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

I have learned English = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

He has bought a painting = He bought the painting in the past and now he has a painting.

Look at the chart about how to form the Present Perfect tense:

We use **have/has + the past participle** of the verb in Present Perfect sentences.

	Past tense form	Past participle form	Example
go	went	gone	<i>I have gone to a lot of football games.</i>
see	saw	seen	<i>She has seen many famous players.</i>
buy	bought	bought	<i>He has bought tickets every year.</i>
hear	heard	heard	<i>They have never heard of the quarterback.</i>

- You can use the contracted form when speaking:

I have = I've

She has = She's

He Has = He's

They have = They've

We have = We've

You have = You've

Find a list of verbs and their past participle forms. Memorize them.

Examples:





Learning Points

- *I have always enjoyed sporting events.*
- *I have had a lot of interesting experiences.*

Used to and Would

Would and **used to** have similar meanings. They are both used to describe something that happened regularly in the past but doesn't happen any longer.

However, there is an important difference between **used to** and **would**.

Would is not used unless you know that the time frame is in the past, while **used to** does not require this.

Read the following example:

We would visit India every summer when we were children.

When we were children refers to a past time frame and therefore makes the meaning of **would** clear.

We used to visit India every summer.

Here, you do not have to include a past time frame since the meaning of **used to** is clear.

Examples:

- *My cousin and I would often go to football games.*
- *We would always buy a hotdog and can of soft drink at the game.*
- *We used to sit near the edge of the field to soak up the atmosphere.*

